

pressing a flashlight to the mirror will let you see if it's one-way and if there's a space behind it. Another easy way to check is to try moving the mirror: if it moves, look behind it, if it's built into the wall, try and find out what's behind it by looking at the layout of the room and the surroundings.

The PC

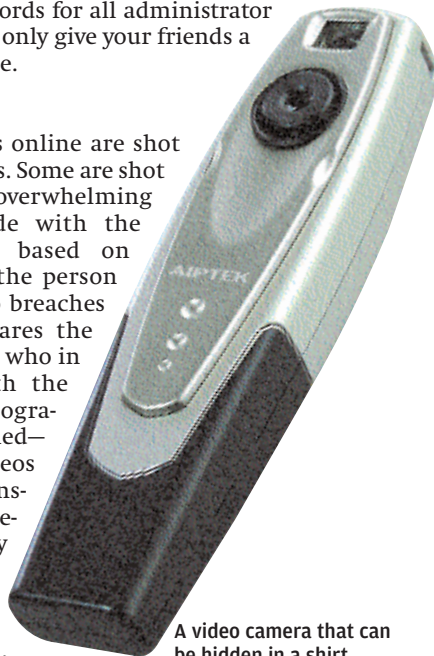
If you think the only way you can be caught with your pants around your ankles is by video or audio devices, think again. Most of the privacy breaches that happen around the world are through PCs. Whether it's gaining access to your bank account passwords, your credit card information, or just your e-mail, it all happens through the PC. The most common places where these breaches in your privacy occur are at cyber cafés and at work! Yes, you read that right—at work!

The people accessing your personal information are not always hackers—these could be your friends, you co-workers, your boss, even your system administrator. Most companies reserve the right to scan through your work e-mails, and it's not against the law. When you use company property, the company has the right to monitor *how* you use that property.

Keyloggers are the biggest threat to your privacy, at home or work. They could be installed by your friends or co-workers, and could give everyone access to your personal life. Most commercial keylogging software is undetectable by anti-virus scanners, and don't even show up in the Task Manager. The safest thing you can do is leave all your personal work for home, on the computer you own and trust. Also, if your home computer is used by friends, make sure you put passwords for all administrator level accounts, and only give your friends a guest account to use.

The Cell Phone

Most voyeur videos online are shot with mobile phones. Some are shot in secret, but the overwhelming majority are made with the victim's consent, based on trust. Sometimes the person shooting the video breaches that trust and shares the video with friends, who in turn share it with the world, or the videographer is himself fooled—and shares the videos unknowingly: transferred over Bluetooth, by exchanging memory cards, or just because of the phone being stolen. If you're smart, and would rather not become the object of every porn-surfing Netizen's fantasy, don't allow yourself to be filmed in compromising positions, no matter how much you trust the person behind the camera!



A video camera that can be hidden in a shirt pocket as a pen



The Visortech Spy Cam is a wireless pin hole camera—the most dangerous type of spy equipment

Stay Safe

If you educate yourself about the technologies available that aid in spying, it will be that much harder to fool you. You also need to inform your families and friends about such threats, and report every such incident to the authorities. If you have friends or family members who take pleasure in being voyeuristic, remind them that what they are doing is illegal and punishable by law. It's also good to put people in the victim's shoes: the line "What if someone did this to your mother/sister/daughter?" seems to put things in the right perspective, and generally acts as a deterrent—not always, but often enough!

Meanwhile, just stay safe and play sensible! ■

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Seriously about
protecting your data
before you
actually lose it.



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